Introduction

Shortly after I retired from the Army in May 2022, I was asked whether I had any plans to write a book. Actually, I didn't. Moreover, I had to seriously get down to completing the thesis for my doctorate, which was long pending. That was my priority. So, although people said that every person has at least one book inside of him, I let it pass. After about six months of sustained work, I was able to submit my thesis, 'Harmonizing Naga Customs, Traditions and Institutions in the Context of Peace and Development' to the Punjabi University, Patiala. With some time on my hands, I started writing a few op-eds for various publications. But still no book.

Sometime later that year, Rachna Bisht requested me to interview for a book on Gen Bipin Rawat that she was working on. When Rachna wrote the book *Bipin: The Man behind the Uniform*, one of the chapters was based on our interaction. I was invited by Gurveen Chadha of Penguin for the book release held in March 2023, at the United Service Institution of India in New Delhi. During the event, I jokingly asked Gurveen, 'When are you publishing my

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